



Steady anchors: Amelia Kerr, the architect of New Zealand's maiden Women's T20 World Cup triumph last year, now stands at the heart of the White Ferns' quest for glory in the ODI arena. **Right:** Heather Knight, having stepped aside as captain, is still central to England's World Cup push. GETTY IMAGES and AP

unprecedented eighth crown. Whether Healy's side can convert continuity into dominance again will define its campaign.

A new era in the making

England, a four-time winner, enters a period of recalibration. The 2022 final loss to Australia exposed flaws — inconsistent batting, over-reliance on a few players, fragile leadership — and the 2025 Ashes whitewash confirmed the need for change.

Edwards, a decorated former captain, has taken over as head coach. With Heather Knight stepping back, Sciver-Brunt now leads a squad in flux.

The new line-up blends experience and fresh energy. Knight, Tammy Beaumont and Sophie Ecclestone form the spine, while Lauren Bell, Emma Lamb and Lauren Filer add dynamism.

A versatile all-round group,

supported by measured pace and quality spin, offers adaptability across conditions. The task is simple but steep: turning potential into consistency.

Old guards, new hopes

New Zealand, winner in 2000, has since wavered between brilliance and underachievement — last reaching a final in 2009 and falling at the group stage as host in 2022.

The succession problem looms large. Suzie Bates, at her fifth World Cup, and Sophie Devine, in her last, remain central but irreplaceable. Their exits leave Amelia Kerr as the bridge between generations.

Kerr, the all-rounder and team's brightest talent, leads a younger group including Georgia Plimmer, Izzy Gaze and Bella James. Whether she can weld promise to experience will decide if the White Ferns rise above recent struggles.

Chasing glory again

The 2025 World Cup is about proving it all over again.

Australia, England and New Zealand arrive with established cores, emerging players and the hunger for more.

Yet in today's game, battles off the field — development systems, depth and cohesion — may matter as much as those on it.

Meanwhile, the chasing pack has honed squads and sharpened combinations, determined finally to convert potential into results.

The champions cannot afford complacency: every rival, from seasoned contenders to ambitious newcomers, will test both skill and resolve.

On the World Cup's grandest stage, history is no guarantee. To lift the trophy again, all three champions must show not only pedigree but reinvention.